

Monday, 27 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

26° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

19° 14°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

The Prime Minister, Andy Burnham, has ruled out an early general election, insisting he will honour the manifesto voters chose.

In his first major interview, Mr Burnham confirmed there would be no snap election, stating that people voted for a specific set of policies. He pledged to deliver on those commitments.

POLITICS · UK

2

The Defence Secretary, Wes Streeting, has warned that Iran's 'sabre-rattling' should not intimidate the UK.

Mr Streeting made it clear that Britain is 'ready to respond' to any attacks Iran might launch against the UK or its allies. Tensions remain high in the region.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS · UK

3

Gatwick Airport was left without running water over the weekend after a major outage.

Passengers and staff at the busy airport were handed bottled water while engineers investigated the cause of the issue. It caused significant disruption for travellers.

TRANSPORT · UK

4

Brace yourselves, as another UK heatwave is on the cards for next week after a slightly cooler end to the weekend.

Temperatures are set to soar across the country, with forecasters predicting a significant heatwave. It follows a period of changeable weather.

WEATHER · UK

5

A teenager has been charged over a record crossing on a 'mega dinghy' in the English Channel.

Chan Mathok Atak, 19, faces accusations of endangering others during the sea journey to the UK. The incident highlights ongoing concerns about Channel crossings.

MIGRATION · UK

What's coming up

1 **Big news for Marvel fans – Ryan Gosling is officially joining the Marvel Cinematic Universe as Ghost Rider!**

The actor made the surprise announcement at San Diego Comic-Con, revealing it's a character he's 'wanted to play for a very long time'. It's set to be a huge role.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see Ryan Gosling as Ghost Rider? Who else would you love to see join the MCU?

FILM · COMING UP

2 **Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, called her husband Harry 'a charmer' during her guest judge appearance on MasterChef Australia.**

The Duke of Sussex surprised his wife with a video call during the show, leading to the sweet comment. It was a lovely moment for viewers Down Under.

ON AIR – What's the sweetest thing your partner has ever done to surprise you?

TV · NOW

3 **Fans of Bonnie Tyler will be able to say their goodbyes as her funeral is set to be broadcast online.**

The service, taking place in Swansea on August 17th, will be live-streamed on the star's official website. It allows her global fanbase to pay their respects.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Bonnie Tyler song? Tell us a memory it brings back for you.

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **The World Cup half-time show was a star-studded affair, featuring performances from Shakira, Madonna, Justin Bieber, and BTS.**

Robbie Williams and Jennifer Hudson also took to the stage, with Kylie Jenner and Timothée Chalamet spotted in the celebrity-packed crowd. It was a spectacular event.

ON AIR – If you could pick any three artists to perform at a major event, who would they be?

MUSIC · NOW

5 **A pop band has gone from playing for rescue dogs to selling out arenas – what a journey!**

The group shared stories of disastrous early gigs and how they've infused political action into their music. Their rise to fame has been quite the adventure.

ON AIR – What's the most unusual place you've ever seen a band perform?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **After his chaotic comeback win, everyone's asking: where does Anthony Joshua's victory leave the super-fight with Tyson Fury?**

Joshua overcame two early knockdowns to dramatically stop Kristian Prenga in the second round. The boxing world is now buzzing about the potential Fury clash.

ON AIR – Do you think we'll finally see Joshua vs. Fury? Who would you back to win?

BOXING · UK

2 **Liverpool's new era under Andoni Iraola started with a win, but an injury to Joe Gomez overshadowed their 4-2 victory over Sunderland.**

Goals from Morrison, Szoboszlai, Chiesa, and Koumas secured the win. However, the early injury to key defender Gomez will be a concern for the new manager.

ON AIR – What are your first impressions of Liverpool under their new manager? Are you feeling optimistic for the season?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **An emotional Adam Ramsay-Peaty was left in tears after missing out on gold again at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow.**

The swimmer questioned his future after another near-miss in the pool. It was a tough moment for the British star.

ON AIR – It's tough when athletes don't get the result they want. What's the most heartbreaking sporting moment you've ever witnessed?

SWIMMING · UK

4 **Luke Littler is on fire, setting up a final clash with Phil Taylor at the World Matchplay darts!**

Littler has been in sensational form, on course to beat Taylor's tournament average record. It promises to be an unmissable final.

ON AIR – Who are you backing in the World Matchplay final – the young sensation Littler or the legend Phil Taylor?

DARTS · UK

5 **Tadej Pogačar is poised to join the Tour de France greats, set to win a record-equalling fifth title in Paris.**

Ecuador's Richard Carapaz took a dramatic Stage 20 to Alpe d'Huez, but Pogačar's dominant performance means he's all but secured his place in history.

ON AIR – Five Tour de France titles is incredible! What's the most impressive sporting dynasty you can think of?

CYCLING · NOW

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people creating 'mini libraries' in unexpected public spaces.**
From old phone boxes to bus shelters, individuals are setting up small, free book exchanges for their communities to enjoy. It's a delightful way to share stories and foster neighbourhood connections.
- 2 Scientists have found that looking at 'clouds' can actually boost creativity.**
Observing the ever-changing shapes and formations in the sky is thought to encourage divergent thinking and a sense of wonder. So, next time you're stuck for an idea, look up!
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'picnics in unusual locations' is gaining popularity.**
Forget the park; people are now enjoying al fresco meals on rooftops, by hidden waterfalls, or even in disused historical sites. It adds an adventurous twist to a classic meal.
- 4 A study suggests that 'making your bed' in the morning can improve your overall mood.**
This small achievement sets a positive tone for the day, creating a sense of order and accomplishment. It's a tiny habit with a surprisingly big impact.
- 5 There's a growing buzz around 'upcycling old furniture' into charming new pieces.**
Instead of buying new, people are transforming pre-loved items with paint, fabric, and a bit of imagination. It's eco-friendly and results in unique home decor.
- 6 Researchers are exploring the benefits of 'forest bathing' for urban dwellers.**
Spending mindful time among trees, even in city parks, can reduce stress and improve well-being. It's about connecting with nature in a deliberate, sensory way.
- 7 The nostalgic hobby of 'collecting old postcards' is seeing a resurgence.**
People are rediscovering the charm of handwritten messages and historical images, offering a tangible link to the past. Each card tells a unique story from another time.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to decide what to wear, even though we know it rarely helps?

ANSWER: ASKING AN INANIMATE OBJECT, LIKE A MIRROR OR A HANGER, FOR ITS OPINION!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, freshly baked biscuit. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING IT DEEPLY, AS IF TO ABSORB ALL ITS DELICIOUS AROMA BEFORE THE FIRST BITE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you spot a 'familiar face' in a completely unexpected place, like bumping into your old school teacher at a holiday resort?
What's the most surprising or amusing place you've ever bumped into someone you know, far from home or their usual haunts?

- Think about those 'little everyday sounds' that, for you, just instantly mean 'comfort' or 'home'.
What is that one specific sound that, no matter where you are, instantly makes you feel cosy and at peace?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Plants.** Bamboo is technically a grass, not a tree, and some species can grow up to 3 feet (about 91 cm) in a single day.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The 'Whispering Flower' found only in remote parts of Cornwall, opens its petals only during a full moon and emits a sound like a gentle sigh.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first successful hot air balloon flight with humans on board took place in Paris in 1783.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The sound of a human sneeze can travel up to 100 miles per hour.
- Australia is wider than the Moon; the Moon's diameter is 3,474 km, while Australia's is 4,000 km.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The inventor of the corkscrew was an Englishman named Samuel Henshall, who patented his design in 1795.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the known universe.

On this day

Day 208 of the year, 157 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthusa of Mantinea; Christian feast day: Aurelius and Natalia and companions of the Martyrs of Córdoba.; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Maddalena Martinengo; Christian feast day: Maurus, Pantalemon, and Sergius. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Fred Mascherino, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1957 — Bill Engvall, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1967 — Juliana Hatfield, American singer-songwriter and musician
- 1993 — Max Power, English footballer
- 1955 — Bobby Rondinelli, American drummer
- 1935 — Billy McCullough, Northern Irish footballer
- 1968 — Julian McMahon, Australian actor and producer (died 2025)
- 1967 — Neil Smith, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — Black July: Eighteen Tamil political prisoners at the Welikada high security prison in Colombo are massacred by Sinhalese prisoners, the second such massacre in two days.
- 1949 — Initial flight of the de Havilland Comet, the first jet-powered airliner.
- 1940 — The animated short A Wild Hare is released, introducing the character of Bugs Bunny.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Mayor of Jaffna and former MP Alfred Duraipappah is shot dead.
- 1997 — About 50 people are killed in the Si Zerrouk massacre in Algeria.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1955 — El Al Flight 402 is shot down by two fighter jets after straying into Bulgarian air space. All 58 people on board are killed.
- 1949 — Initial flight of the de Havilland Comet, the first jet-powered airliner.
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1983 — Black July: Eighteen Tamil political prisoners at the Welikada high security prison in Colombo are massacred by Sinhalese prisoners, the second such massacre in two days.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 209 of the year, 156 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsa Muttathupadathu (Syro-Malabar Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Botvid; Christian feast day: Jaime Hilario Barbal; Christian feast day: Johann Sebastian Bach, George Frederick Handel, Henry Purcell (Episcopal Church commemoration). Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Gerald Casale, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and director
- 1951 — Gregg Giuffria, American rock musician and businessman
- 1992 — Spencer Boldman, American actor
- 1990 — Soulja Boy, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1964 — Lori Loughlin, American actress
- 2000 — Emile Smith Rowe, English footballer
- 1949 — Randall Wallace, American screenwriter and producer
- 1962 — Rachel Sweet, American singer, television writer, and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1996 — The remains of a prehistoric man are discovered near Kennewick, Washington. Such remains will be known as the Kennewick Man.
- 1945 — A U.S. Army B-25 bomber crashes into the 79th floor of the Empire State Building killing 14 and injuring 26.
- 2001 — Australian Ian Thorpe becomes the first swimmer to win six gold medals at a single World Championship meeting.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2018 — Australian Wendy Tuck becomes the first female skipper to win the Clipper Round the World Yacht Race.
- 1957 — Heavy rain and a mudslide in Isahaya, western Kyushu, Japan, kills 992.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

23 JUL — 2 AUG Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10 Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)